

WILLY (WEI-LI) CHEN

Old Botany Rm 5, Michigan State University | East Lansing, MI

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EDUCATION

Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI

August 2022 – Present

Doctor of Philosophy - Economics

- ICER NASA Open Scholarship Fellow

Fall 2026

- Summer Research Fellowship

Summer 2026

- Peter Schmidt [Outstanding First-Year Student] Award

Summer 2023

The University of Chicago, Chicago, IL

October 2019 – August 2020

Master of Arts in Social Sciences—Economics

- Phoenix Research Award

- Director's Scholarship

The Ohio State University, Columbus, OH

August 2015 – May 2019

Bachelor of Science in Mathematics—Theoretical

Bachelor of Science in Economics—Summa Cum Laude with Research Distinction

TECHNICAL SKILLS AND RESEARCH INTERESTS

- US Sailing Small Boat Sailing Level 1 Instructor
- Data Analytics and Econometrics: Stata, R, Python, PostgreSQL, L^AT_EX, Large Language Model training, SLURM high performance computing workflow
- Languages: Fluent in English, Taiwanese, and Taiwanese Mandarin
- Interests: Economics of Inequality, Labor Economics

SERVICES

- Director of Event Planning, MSU Council of Graduate Students

May 2025 - Present

- Social Chair, Department of Economics

August 2023 - Aug 2024

JOB MARKET PAPER

Discounted Degrees: Employer Frictions and the Misallocation of High-Skilled Immigrants

PEER-REVIEWED PAPERS

Elbel, B., Zhou, G. E., Lee, D. C., Chen, W., Day, S. E., Konty, K. J., & Schwartz, A. E. (2022). *Analysis of School-Level Vaccination Rates by Race, Ethnicity, and Geography in New York City*. JAMA network open, 5(9), e2231849-e2231849.

WORKING PAPERS

Chen, Willy and Qiao, Xiao and Zhang, Hanzhe, Over a Century of Economics Research Collaboration (May 21, 2025). Available at SSRN: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=5263564> or <http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5263564>

Toossi, Saied and Schwartz, Amy Ellen and Chen, Willy, The Relationship between Entrée Variety and Student Participation in School Lunch (August 01, 2025). Available at SSRN: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=5378789> or <http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5378789>

Chen, Willy, (Resubmitted to Social Choice and Welfare) Descriptive Units of Heterogeneity: An Axiomatic Approach to Measuring Heterogeneity (July 23, 2024). Available at SSRN: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=4952556> or <http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.4952556>

WORK IN PROGRESS

Understanding Immigrant Occupational Mismatch: The Role of Intra-Household Bargaining and Employer-Sponsored Health Insurance (with Elif Dilden)

Talent Reallocation Amid Silicon Valley Tech Layoffs (with Hannah Bae and Xintong Li)

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI

August 2020 – Present

- **MSU Sailing Center**
 - *Lead Instructor—Small Boat Sailing—Summer '26*
 - *Assistant Instructor—Small Boat Sailing—Summer '25*
- **Economics Course Instructor :**
 - *EC201—Introduction to Microeconomics—Spartan Early Start Session, Summer '25*
- **Economics Courses Teaching Assistant:**
 - *EC251H/EC301—Intermediate Microeconomics (Fall '22, '24, '25; Spring '26)*
 - *EC812B—PhD Game Theory (Spring '24, '25, '26)*
- **Economics Graduate Research Assistant:**
 - *Hanzhe Zhang (Fall '23; Summer '24)*

Syracuse University, Syracuse, NY

September 2020 – May 2022

Research Associate, Center for Policy Research

The University of Chicago, Chicago, IL

September 2019 – June 2020

Teaching Assistant, ECON 100/200/201

REFERENCES

Todd Elder (Dissertation Co-Chair) telder@msu.edu

Title: MSU Foundation Professor of Economics, Michigan State University

Hanzhe Zhang (Dissertation Co-Chair) hanzhe@msu.edu

Title: Mark A. Simon Distinguished Associate Professor of Economics, Michigan State University

Stephen Woodbury (Dissertation Committee Member) woodbur2@msu.edu

Title: Professor of Economics, Michigan State University